issues related to national security and war-gamed various scenarios. The emphasis was on out-of-the-box thinking.

On completion of the course, I was expecting my first posting to the Army HQ based on my qualifications and experience, and having put in twenty years of service. Instead, I got posted to Jammu in HQ 26 Infantry Division. Mine was an 'early bird' problem. I was not due to become a colonel for another year and therefore, I was posted as assistant quarter master general in the rank I was holding. This tenure in J&K was for a year. My charter of duties mainly involved the planning and execution of logistics support to the units and formations in the division. Logisticians are the unsung heroes in most armies. Good logistics planning can be a great force multiplier and morale booster. Whereas an operational staff officer faces a challenge only when there is war or during an exercise in peacetime, the logistics staff officer faces a challenge everyday – war or no war! We remained quite busy as Jammu has always been a very important administrative base for J&K, right from the days of the Indo–Pak war of 1947–48. There is never a dull moment as Jammu is a road, rail and air hub for the army deployed in Kashmir. We had to coordinate the movements, and provide logistics support to men, animals (mules), transport and material. The tonnages were mind-boggling.

Life in the Jammu cantonment was peaceful. Since my high school years (1957–60), a lot had changed in Jammu. It was not a one-street town any longer. It was a nice feeling when we met old friends there. Consequent to the sad and unfortunate assassination of Prime Minister Indira Gandhi on 31 October 1984 by her guards, anti-Sikh riots broke out in many parts of the country, particularly in north India. We had a sizeable Sikh population in Jammu. Major General J.S. (Jimmy) Rawat, who happened to be our commanding general at Jammu, discussed the matter with his staff and ordered precautionary flag marches by the army in vehicles. I think the GOC's mature and wise decision had probably saved many innocent lives, as there were hardly any incidents of rioting reported in